



# Moving Forward With Trust

## Designing Human Accountability Into a Gen AI Workflow

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Ken Judy · Senior Partner, Stride Consulting  
[kenjudy.us](http://kenjudy.us) · [stride.build](http://stride.build)



Artificial Intelligence ›

Effect on the Economy

A.I. and Campaigns

Transition for Workers

Anthropic's A.I. Model

China Closing the A.I. Gap

# *Xbox Hits Reset Button, Laying Off Thousands and Dropping Game Studios*

The layoffs were part of wider cuts at Microsoft, as the company prioritizes spending on artificial intelligence.

The initial Xbox layoffs are part of **4,800 job cuts** that Microsoft announced on Monday, a total that accounts for roughly **2 percent of the company's work force**. It is Microsoft's latest employee culling as it plows tens of billions of dollars into the infrastructure for building artificial intelligence.

# Software development is a design process



**M**anufacturing automates the repeated execution of a known solution. **D**esign is the activity of discovering the right solution under uncertainty.

When AI is applied to an undisciplined design process, it speeds up output without improving judgment. You get more of the wrong things faster.

(thank you Mary Poppendieck - author of Lean Software Development)

**Act on anything that  
went wrong to avoid  
errors of the same  
nature in future**

**Plan**

**Plan what you are  
doing**

**Act**

**Do**

**Check**

**Do what you said  
you'd do**

**Check that you did it  
right**

# PDCA Cycle Applied to a Human In The Loop Agentic Workflow

## Plan

Analyze the problem broadly tied to a positive user focused outcome

Task out the execution using templated guardrails

Agent is instructed to raise questions of clarification and present artifacts for approval.

## Do

Execute in small atomic steps. Rely on programmatic deterministic steps where possible. Rely on Gen AI where fuzzy logic is helpful.

Enforce a feedback loop where the agent is showing its progress at each meaningful step.

## Check

Completion analysis:  
agent reviews session transcript and generated code against original plan. Verifies against an explicit definition of done.

Agent is instructed to report back with validation points not just a conclusion.

## Act

Micro-retrospective.  
Agent analyzes what worked and identifies targeted refinements to prompts and interaction patterns for the next cycle.

Agent is instructed to ask socratic questions to elicit insight from the human.

## Step 1: Plan



**W**hat is the task, and what does a completed cycle deliver?

*Example: “Preparing my weekly status update for my manager and key stakeholders — delivers a reviewed, sent update covering what shipped, what's at risk, and what I need from others.”*

## Step 2: Do



**W**hat requires human judgment that can't be delegated to AI?

**W**hat can AI execute autonomously, with review at defined gates?

**W**hat are the irreversible or highest-stakes moments?

**W**hat AI behavior should trigger an immediate STOP?

## Step 3: Check



**N**ame 3-5 specific, observable signals of success.

**W**hat are the most common failure modes to prevent?



## Step 4: Act



**W**hat process debt accumulates when this is repeated?

**W**hat do you want to learn and improve each cycle?

Plan

Think through  
the questions

Do

Run the prompt  
builder prompt

Check

Evaluate the  
prompt by doing  
test run(s)

Act

Use the agent to  
help you refine  
the prompt



## Resources:

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ken@kenjudy.us | kjudy@stride.build

Human directed ai workflow skill:

<https://github.com/kenjudy/human-directed-ai-workflow-builder>

